

I'm going to go out on a limb here and say that I think arranged marriage can often work. I'm not talking about forced marriage, where one or both partners are unduly or totally coerced. I'm talking about consenting adults who've met through familial arrangements where the best interests of all parties factor into the partnership. It may sound crazy, but often your parents and relatives are the people who are best equipped to help you make this all-important decision. "Hold it right there, Mr. Wonderful," you say. "Arranged marriage is politically incorrect. It's a throwback to a time of barbarians." At which point I'd suggest you look at the statistics. Canada's national divorce rate is 40 percent. The average global divorce rate of arranged marriages is 4 percent. All I'm suggesting here is that it's possible that the divorce rate in arranged marriages is lower because those entering into that agreement have entered with awareness and due diligence.

Why should this matter to you? Why is Uncle Kevin suddenly hell-bent on matchmaking? I'm not. I'll leave that to Auntie. But I am interested in helping you make and keep your money, and *there is no greater threat to your family dynasty than divorce*. If you want to get married, it should be your topmost priority to *stay* married. I don't care who you are: the financial damage (not to mention emotional damage) you will incur from a divorce is colossal.

We like to think of ourselves as advanced and savvy, a far cry from our forebears. So how, with all our education, our so-called experts and our libraries full of self-help books on healthy relationships, are we failing at marriage? Is it possible that when we try to find a partner in a vacuum, stripped out of any larger social context and without the involvement of our families, we are *doing it wrong*?